

Kerala wore a beautiful blue sky with cirrus clouds for the wedding of John and Nicola. Birds sang. The wind stayed faithfully with the hundred guests dressed in traditional Kerala attire, who flew in from Europe, New Zealand, South Africa and the United States. At the pier, a special honeymoon houseboat bobbed. Strains of the *nadaswaram* filled the air. The priest chanted the sacred prayers. As the music reached a gentle crescendo, John tied the *thali* around Nicola's neck. They circled the sacred fire thrice. They exchanged rings. And were then pronounced husband and wife. As John and Nicola cruised into a magnificent sunset from Bolgatty Island, they fulfilled their long cherished dream – to get married in the most beautiful place on earth. All that remained was to live happily ever after.

After scouting the whole world, John and Nicola chose heaven.

What's your experience? Log on to www.keralatourism.org and record your real-life Kerala experience, which could win you a free holiday. Or plan your first ever holiday in *God's Own Country*, inspired by an amazing range of true stories like that of John Foreman and Nicola Pauling, natives of New Zealand, who live and work in London, England.

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